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Polyurethane foam

Abstract

A polyurethane foam is disclosed having unique load bearing characteristics rendering it suitable for a variety of applications. The foam exhibits high surface-softness and smoothness properties, making it well-suited for use in articles such as pillows and mattress toppers. However, upon continued application of pressure, the resilience of the foam increases sharply, translating into a remarkable support characteristics that make the foam suitable for use in the seat portions of chairs and sofas, as well as in the base portion of mattresses. The foams therefore address the limitations of conventional, high-resilience and visco-elastic polyurethane foams. A process of making the foam and its use in various articles is also disclosed.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/491,624, filed on Sep. 6, 2019, which is the U.S. national stage filing, under 35 U.S.C. § 371 (c), of International Application No. PCT/CN2018/078261, filed on Mar. 7, 2018, which claims priority to United Kingdom Patent Application No. 1703738.3, filed on Mar. 8, 2017. CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (2) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/491,624, filed on Sep. 6, 2019, which is the U.S. national stage filing, under 35 U.S.C. § 371(c), of International Application No. PCT/CN2018/078261, filed on Mar. 7, 2018, which claims priority to United Kingdom Patent Application No. 1703738.3, filed on Mar. 8, 2017.

INTRODUCTION

(1) The present invention relates to a polyurethane foam, as well as to its method of manufacture and its use in articles and applications requiring cushioning and/or support.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Flexible polyurethane foams typically fall into one of three principle categories. Although conventional foam, high-resilience (HR) foam and visco-elastic foam (also known as memory foam) are all generally useful in the bedding and furniture sphere, their individual characteristics renders each foam particularly suited to certain applications. Owing to its flexibility and support properties, conventional foam, is traditionally used in the back portion of seats and chairs, as well as the base portion of mattresses. HR foam, offering good body support and resilience, is well-suited for use in the seat portion of seats, chairs and sofas. Visco-elastic is typically used in the manufacture of pillows, the upper portion of mattresses and in mattress toppers, where its shape-conforming, energy-attenuating and sound dampening properties are particularly advantageous.

(3) In spite of the usefulness of conventional, HR and visco-elastic foams, there exist numerous applications for which it would be advantageous to combine the benefits of multiple foam types. Efforts to address this need by combining two or more foam types into a given article—for example in discrete laminated layers—have proved unsuccessful, owing in part to the resulting composite foam exhibiting undesirable properties at the interface of the individual foams.

(4) There is therefore a need for a new type of foam that combines the advantages of conventional, HR and visco-elastic foams into a single material. In addition, in order to maximize the applicability of the material across multiple applications, there is an ongoing need for a foam that exhibits other advantageous properties, such as high sag value and increased surface softness and smoothness.

(5) The present invention was devised with the foregoing in mind.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) According to a first aspect of the present invention there is provided a process for the preparation of a polyurethane foam, the process comprising/consisting essentially of/consisting of the steps of: a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 72-110, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.4-1.0 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-4.0 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

(7) According to a second aspect of the present invention there is provided a polyurethane foam obtainable, obtained or directly obtained by the process according to the first aspect of the invention.

(8) According to a third aspect of the present invention there is provided a polyurethane foam having a sag value of 2.8-3.5, wherein the sag value is calculated according to the following expression:

$$(9) \text{ SagValue} = \frac{\text{IFD}_{65\%}}{\text{IFD}_{25\%}}$$

and wherein IFD65% and IFD25% values are determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008.

(10) According to a fourth aspect of the present invention there is provided an article comprising a polyurethane foam according to the second or third aspect of the invention.

(11) According to a further aspect of the present invention there is provided a process for the preparation of a polyurethane foam, the process comprising/consisting essentially of/consisting of the steps of: a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 65-90, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.4-1.0 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.1-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, and v. water in an amount of 1.5-4.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(12) Preparation of Polyurethane Foam

(13) As described hereinbefore, the present invention provides a process for the preparation of a polyurethane foam, the process comprising the steps of: a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 72-110, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.4-1.0 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-4.0 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

(14) Against the backdrop of conventional, HR and visco-elastic flexible polyurethane foams, the

present inventor has now devised a process that surprisingly allows the benefits of each of these foams to be combined into a single new flexible polyurethane foam. In particular, foams obtainable by the present process combine the support and pressure-reducing characteristics of conventional, HR and visco-elastic foam, whilst simultaneously offering noticeably improved surface smoothness and softness. Such characteristics are attributable, at least in part, to the unique load-bearing properties of those foams obtainable by the present process. In particular, the present process results in foams that exhibit a high degree of surface softness and smoothness upon initial application of pressure to the foam's surface. However, upon continued application of pressure, the foam's resistance to compression increases sharply, thus offering increased resilience and support. As a consequence, the foams obtainable by the present process are not only well-suited to applications requiring robust support, such as in seats and mattress bases, but are equally useful in articles that are intended to be pleasing to the touch, such as mattress surfaces and mattress toppers.

(15) Optionally, those ingredients mixed in step a) comprise at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol. The resulting foams exhibit BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy. BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy is a UK requirement which is perhaps the most stringent of all international flame retardancy standards. Achieving high surface-softness, high sag value and BS5852 crib 5 compliance in a single polyurethane foam is particularly advantageous.

(16) In an embodiment, the ingredients specified in step a) are mixed at a speed of 2,000-8,000 rpm. Suitably, the ingredients specified in step a) are mixed at a speed of 4,000-6,000 rpm.

(17) In an embodiment, the polyol, which is suitably a polyether polyol, has an average molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da. Suitably, the polyol has an average molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da.

(18) In an embodiment, the polyol has an OH functionality of 2.5-3.5. The OH functionality describes the average number of OH groups in a molecule of polyol, and can be calculated according to the following expression:

$$(19) \text{OH functionality} = \frac{\text{total moles OH}}{\text{total moles polyol}}$$

Suitably, the polyol has an OH functionality of 2.8-3.2.

(20) In an embodiment, the polyol has an OH value of 20-48. The OH value (also known as OH number) is the milligrams of potassium hydroxide equivalent to the hydroxyl content in one gram of polyol, and can be calculated according to the following expression:

$$(21) \text{OH value} = \frac{56100 * \text{OH functionality}}{\text{equivalent weight of polyol}}$$

Suitably, the polyol has an OH value of 23-33. More suitably, the polyol has an OH value of 26-30.

(22) Suitably, only one polyol (e.g. a polyether polyol) is used in step a).

(23) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 28-33%. The NCO content (expressed as a percentage) describes the weight percentage of NCO groups in an isocyanate-containing material. Suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%. More suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-31%. Most suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-30.5%.

(24) Suitably, methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is the only isocyanate used in step a).

(25) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is a modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate.

(26) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a density at 25° C. of 1.0-1.4 g cm.sup.-3. More suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a density at 25° C. of 1.1-1.3 g cm.sup.-3.

(27) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a viscosity at 25° C. of 45-85 mPa s. Suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a viscosity at 25° C. of 55-75 mPa s. More suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a viscosity at 25° C. of 60-70 mPa s.

(28) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a flash point (according to the Cleveland Cup ASTM method D92) at 25° C. of 180-230° C. Suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has a flash point at 25° C. of 195-215° C.

(29) In an embodiment, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is a modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having a density at 25° C. of 1.1-1.3 gcm.sup.-3, a viscosity at 25° C. of 55-75 mPa s, and a flash point at 25° C. of 195-215° C.

(30) In an embodiment, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105. Suitably, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 80-103. More suitably, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 85-100. Even more suitably, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 87-95. Most suitably, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92.

(31) In another embodiment, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 70-80. Alternatively, the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-78.

(32) Any surfactant suitable for use in the preparation of a polyurethane foam may be used. Suitable surfactants are well known to the skilled person, and include polydiethylsiloxane-polyoxyalkylene block copolymers, silicone oils and nonylphenol ethoxylates. Suitably, the surfactant is a silicone oil.

(33) In an embodiment, in step a), the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.4-0.8 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, in step a), the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.5-0.8 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol. Most suitably, in step a), the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.55-0.75 per hundred parts polyol.

(34) Alternatively, in step a), the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.45-0.65 per hundred parts polyol.

(35) In an embodiment, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol. Suitable amine catalysts include triethylenediamine (TEDA), dimethylcyclohexylamine (DMCHA), triethylene diamine, bis(2-dimethyl amino ethyl)ether (BDE) and dimethylethanolamine (DMEA). Most suitably, the catalyst is triethylene diamine.

(36) In an embodiment, in step a), the amine catalyst is present in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, in step a), the amine catalyst is present in an amount of 0.45-0.55 per hundred parts polyol.

(37) Alternatively, in step a), the amine catalyst is present in an amount of 0.2-0.4 or 0.25-0.35 per hundred parts polyol.

(38) In an embodiment, in step a), water is present in an amount of 1.5-3.5 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, in step a), water is present in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, in step a), water is present in an amount of 1.75-2.8 per hundred parts polyol. Most suitably, in step a), water is present in an amount of 1.75-2.5 per hundred parts polyol.

(39) Alternatively, in step a), water is present in an amount of 2.0-3.5 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, in step a), water is present in an amount of 2.5-3.5 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, in step a), water is present in an amount of 2.9-3.3 per hundred parts polyol.

(40) In an embodiment, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 5.0-14.0 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 8.0-13.5 per hundred parts polyol. Even more suitably, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 10.0-13.0 per hundred parts polyol.

(41) Alternatively, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 4.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, the flame retardant is present in an amount of 6.0-8.0 per hundred parts polyol.

(42) When included in step a), the flame retardant may be a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof.

- (43) When included in step a), the flame retardant may be used in conjunction with a flame-retardant synergist. Suitably, the synergist is present in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, the synergist is present in an amount of 9.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol. Most suitably, the synergist is present in an amount of 13.0-16.0 per hundred parts polyol.
- (44) Alternatively, the synergist is present in an amount of 8.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, the synergist is present in an amount of 8.0-12.0 per hundred parts polyol.
- (45) The synergist may be melamine or melamine-based.
- (46) In an embodiment, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.2. Suitably, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol. More suitably, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.05 per hundred parts polyol.
- (47) When included in step a), any tin catalyst suitable for use in the preparation of a polyurethane foam may be used. Suitable tin catalysts are well known to the skilled person, and include dibutyltin dioctanoate, dibutyltin dilaurate and tin alkyl carboxylates (e.g. stannous octoate). In an embodiment, the tin catalyst is a mild Lewis acid. Suitably, the tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate (e.g. stannous octoate).
- (48) In an embodiment, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.2-1.5 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol.
- (49) Alternatively, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.6-1.2 per hundred parts polyol.
- (50) When included in step a), any chain extender and/or cross linker suitable for use in the preparation of a polyurethane foam may be used. Suitable chain extenders and/or cross linkers are well known to the skilled person, and include ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine. In an embodiment, the chain extender and/or cross linker is diethanol amine.
- (51) In an embodiment, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one cell opener in an amount of 1.0-6.0 per hundred parts polyol. Suitably, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol.
- (52) When included in step a), any cell opener suitable for use in the preparation of a polyurethane foam may be used. Suitable cell openers are well known to the skilled person, and include silicone-based compounds and polyol-based compounds. In an embodiment, the cell opener is a polyol-based compound.
- (53) In an embodiment, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol. Considering that the presence of water in step a) is mandatory (which reacts with the isocyanate to produce CO₂), the presence of a dedicated blowing agent is optional. Suitably, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol.
- (54) Alternatively, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one blowing agent in an amount of 6.0-8.0 per hundred parts polyol.
- (55) When included in step a), any blowing agent suitable for use in the preparation of a polyurethane foam may be used. Suitable blowing agents are well known to the skilled person, and include that materials that are capable of absorbing heat from the exothermic reactions, vaporizing and providing additional gas useful in expanding the foam to a lower density. In an embodiment, the blowing agent is methylene chloride.
- (56) In an embodiment, those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise a pigment.
- (57) In an embodiment, in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured in an atmosphere of air.
- (58) In an embodiment, in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured at a temperature of

15-40° C.

(59) In an embodiment, in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured at a pressure of 0.9 to 1.1 bar.

(60) In an embodiment, in step b), the foam is cured for 24-120 hours. Suitably, in step b), the foam is cured for 48-96 hours.

(61) In an embodiment, the process is continuous (as opposed to a batch or discontinuous process). Suitably, foam is formed at a speed of 3-5 m/min.

(62) In an embodiment, in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min.

(63) Suitably, in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 110-130 kg/min.

(64) In an embodiment, in step a), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min. Suitably, in step a), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 40-60 kg/min.

(65) In an embodiment, in step a), the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 45-85 kg/min. Suitably, in step a), the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 55-75 kg/min.

(66) In an embodiment, in step a), the amine catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 20-50 kg/min. Suitably, in step a), the amine catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-40 kg/min.

(67) In an embodiment, in step a), water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2-6 kg/min. Suitably, in step a), water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 3-5 kg/min.

(68) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the flame retardant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 5-12 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the flame retardant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 7-10 kg/min.

(69) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the flame retardant synergist is fed to a mixer at a rate of 8-16 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the flame retardant synergist is fed to a mixer at a rate of 10-14 kg/min.

(70) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the blowing agent is fed to a mixer at a rate of 5-12 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the blowing agent is fed to a mixer at a rate of 7-10 kg/min.

(71) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the tin catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.01-0.07 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the tin catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.025-0.055 kg/min.

(72) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the cell opener is fed to a mixer at a rate of 1-6 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the cell opener is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2.5-4.5 kg/min.

(73) In an embodiment, when it features in step a), the chain extender and/or cross linker is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.1-3.0 kg/min. Suitably, when it features in step a), the chain extender and/or cross linker is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.5-1.5 kg/min.

(74) In an embodiment, the ingredients specified in step a) are mixed at a pressure of 0.2-0.4 mPa.

(75) In an embodiment, the process is as defined in any one of numbered paragraphs (1)-(30): 1) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-4.0 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 2) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 72-110, iii. at

least one surfactant in an amount of 0.4-1.0 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

3) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

4) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 4.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

5) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, and vi. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

6) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and vii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

7) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.2 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

8) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per

hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

9) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.2-1.5 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

10) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

11) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one cell opener in an amount of 1.0-6.0 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

12) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

13) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in

an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

14) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, vi. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and viii. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

15) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one cell opener in an amount of 1.0-6.0 per hundred parts polyol, vii. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and ix. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

16) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, vii. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and ix. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

17) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.2 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.2-1.5 per hundred parts polyol, vii. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and ix. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

18) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount

of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and ix. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

19) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.2 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.2-1.5 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 1.0-6.0 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

20) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

21) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-105, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.5-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.5-3.3 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 6.5-14.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 9.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

22) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 87-95, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.45-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts

polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.75-2.8 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 8.0-13.5 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 9.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 23) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 87-95, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.8 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.45-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.75-2.6 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 8.0-13.5 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 9.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 24) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.45-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.1 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.75-2.5 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 10.0-13.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 13.0-16.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 25) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.85 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.45-0.55 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.5-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.5-8.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.75-2.5 per hundred parts polyol, x. optionally at least one flame retardant in an amount of 10.0-13.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. optionally at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 13.0-16.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 26) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 73-77, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.45-0.65 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.2-0.4 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.01-0.05 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.7-0.9 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 5.0-9.0 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 3.0-3.4 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 5.0-9.0 per hundred parts

polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-12.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 27) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.85 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.4-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.03-0.07 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.45-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 3.5-7.5 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.8-2.2 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 2.0-4.0 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 13.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 28) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.85 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.4-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.03-0.07 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.45-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 3.5-7.5 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 3.8-4.0 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 10.5-13.5 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 13.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 29) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.85 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.4-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.03-0.07 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.45-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 3.5-7.5 per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 2.0-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, ix. water in an amount of 1.8-2.0 per hundred parts polyol, x. at least one flame retardant in an amount of 10.5-13.5 per hundred parts polyol, and xi. at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 13.0-17.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 30) a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 88-92, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.55-0.85 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.4-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, v. at least one tin catalyst in an amount of 0.03-0.07 per hundred parts polyol, vi. at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.45-0.75 per hundred parts polyol, vii. at least one blowing agent in an amount of 1.0- per hundred parts polyol, viii. at least one cell opener in an amount of 4.5-5.5 per hundred parts polyol, and ix. water in an amount of 1.8-2.0 per hundred parts polyol, b) curing the mixture resulting from step a).

(76) In any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol, methylene diphenyl diisocyanate,

surfactant, amine catalyst, water, flame retardant, flame retardant synergist, tin catalyst, chain extender/cross linker, cell opener and/or blowing agent may have any of the definitions recited hereinbefore.

(77) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol, which is suitably a polyether polyol, has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da or 7,500-8,500 Da. Suitably, the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da or 7,750-8,250 Da.

(78) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has an OH value of 20-48 or 26-30.

(79) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), only one polyol is provided in step a).

(80) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da and an OH value of 26-30.

(81) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 28-33% or 29-32%. Suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-31%. Most suitably, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-30.5%.

(82) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is a modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having a density at 25° C. of 1.1-1.3 gcm.sup.-3, a viscosity at 25° C. of 55-75 mPa s, and a flash point at 25° C. of 195-215° C.

(83) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is the only isocyanate used in step a).

(84) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the surfactant is a silicone oil.

(85) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol.

(86) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof.

(87) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based.

(88) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate.

(89) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the chain extender and/or cross linker is selected from ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine.

(90) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the cell opener is a polyol-based compound.

(91) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the blowing agent is methylene chloride.

(92) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, and the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 28-33%.

(93) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da and an OH value of 20-48, and the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%.

(94) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da and an OH value of 26-30, and the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%.

(95) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da and an OH value of 26-30, and the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is a modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having a density at 25° C. of 1.1-1.3 gcm.sup.-3, a viscosity at 25° C. of 55-75 mPa s, a flash point at 25° C. of 195-215° C., and an NCO content of 29-32%.

(96) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, and the surfactant is a silicone oil.

(97) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, and the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol.

(98) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, and the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof.

(99) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, and the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based.

(100) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, and tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate.

(101) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate, and the chain extender and/or cross linker is selected from ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine.

(102) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da and an OH value of 20-48, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate, the chain extender and/or cross linker is selected from ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine, the cell opener is a polyol-based compound, and the blowing agent is methylene chloride.

(103) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, and the surfactant is a silicone oil.

(104) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, and the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol.

(105) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, and the flame retardant is a chlorinated

phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof.

(106) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, and the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based.

(107) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, and tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate.

(108) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate, and the chain extender and/or cross linker is selected from ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine.

(109) In an embodiment, in any of the numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,500-8,500 Da (or 7,250-8,250 Da) and an OH value of 26-30, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 29-32%, the surfactant is a silicone oil, the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol, the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof, the flame retardant synergist is melamine or melamine-based, tin catalyst is a tin alkyl carboxylate, the chain extender and/or cross linker is selected from ethylene glycol, 1,4-butanediol, ethanol amine and diethanol amine, the cell opener is a polyol-based compound, and the blowing agent is methylene chloride.

(110) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), the ingredients specified in step a) are mixed at a speed of 2,000-8,000 rpm, preferably 4,000-6,000 rpm.

(111) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step a), the polyol, methylene diphenyl diisocyanate, surfactant, amine catalysts, water, flame retardant, flame retardant synergist, blowing agent, tin catalyst, cell opener and/or chain extender/cross linker may be fed to a mixer at any of the rates specified hereinbefore.

(112) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min, and the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min.

(113) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min, the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 45-85 kg/min, the amine catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 20-50 kg/min, and water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2-6 kg/min.

(114) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min, the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 45-85 kg/min, the amine catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 20-50 kg/min, water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2-6 kg/min, and the flame retardant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 5-12 kg/min.

(115) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min, the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min, the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 45-85 kg/min, the amine catalyst

is fed to a mixer at a rate of 20-50 kg/min, water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2-6 kg/min, the flame retardant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 5-12 kg/min, the flame retardant synergist is fed to a mixer at a rate of 8-16 kg/min, the blowing agent is fed to a mixer at a rate of 5-12 kg/min, tin catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.01-0.07 kg/min, the cell opener is fed to a mixer at a rate of 1-6 kg/min, and the chain extender and/or cross linker is fed to a mixer at a rate of 0.1-3.0 kg/min.

(116) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (1)-(30), in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured in an atmosphere of air at a temperature of 15-40° C.

(117) Polyurethane Foam

(118) As described hereinbefore, the present invention provides a polyurethane foam obtainable by the process according to the first aspect of the invention.

(119) As described hereinbefore, the present invention provides a polyurethane foam having a sag value of 2.8-3.5, wherein the sag value is calculated according to the following expression:

$$(120) \text{SagValue} = \frac{\text{IFD65\%}}{\text{IFD25\%}}$$

and wherein IFD65% and IFD25% values are determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008.

(121) The flexible polyurethane foams of the present invention offer a variety of surprising advantages over known polyurethane foams. Perhaps most notably, the present invention has allowed certain desirable properties exhibited across conventional, HR and visco-elastic flexible polyurethane foams to be brought together into a single polyurethane foam. In particular, the foams of the present invention combine the support and pressure-reducing characteristics of conventional, HR and visco-elastic foam, whilst simultaneously offering noticeably improved surface smoothness and softness. Such characteristics are attributable, at least in part, to the unique load bearing properties of the foams of the present invention. In particular, the present foams exhibit a high degree of surface softness and smoothness upon initial application of pressure to the foam's surface. However, upon continued application of pressure, the foam's resistance to compression increases sharply, thus offering increased resilience and support. As a consequence, the present foams are not only well-suited to applications requiring robust support, such as in seats and mattress bases, but are equally useful in articles that are intended to be pleasing to the touch, such as mattress surfaces and mattress toppers.

(122) The following paragraphs are applicable to the polyurethane foams of both the second and third aspects of the invention.

(123) The polyurethane foam has a sag value of 2.8-3.5. The sag value is a parameter commonly used in the foam industry to describe the load bearing characteristics of a given foam. With this industry, the sag value is calculated according to the following expression:

$$(124) \text{SagValue} = \frac{\text{IFD65\%}}{\text{IFD25\%}}$$

(125) IFD (indentation force deflection, previously indentation load deflection) is one test method to determine the load bearing characteristics (firmness or stiffness) of a foam, and is expressed in Newtons at a given percent deflection of the foam. To obtain the IFD25% value, a 200 mm diameter flat circular indenter plate is driven into a square foam sample (380 mm side length, 50 mm thickness), stopping when it reaches a deflection of 12.5 mm (25% of the 50 mm thickness). The testing device records the force required to hold this foam indented for 30 seconds. The higher the force reading, the higher the load bearing capacity of the foam. The ISO Standard entitled "Flexible cellular polymeric materials—Determination of hardness (indentation technique) (ISO 2439:2008) English version of DIN EN ISO 2439:2009-05" (referred to generally herein as ISO 2439:2008) provides further details of how IFD and sag value are calculated at paragraph 7.4 Method B.

(126) The sag value (also known as sag factor or compressive deflection coefficient) is the ratio of the IFD65% value to the IFD25% value and is expressed in real numbers with one decimal. The sag value gives an indication of cushioning quality, and a high value indicates a resistance to "bottoming out." The sag value properties of the present foams reflects the advantageous load

bearing properties discussed above.

(127) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has a sag value of 3.0-3.5. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has a sag value of 3.1-3.4. More suitably, the polyurethane foam has a sag value of 3.2-3.4.

(128) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has an IFD25% value of 10-40. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD25% value of 20-30.

(129) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 33-80. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 40-70. More suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 40-55.

(130) Alternatively, polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 20-50. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 30-40.

(131) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 50-115. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 50-100. More suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 70-95. Most suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 72-85.

(132) Alternatively, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 60-90. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 65-75.

(133) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has a density of 35-60 kg/m.^{sup.3}. Suitably, the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-60 kg/m.^{sup.3}. More suitably, the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-55 kg/m.^{sup.3}. Even more suitably, the polyurethane foam has a density of 45-50 kg/m.^{sup.3}.

(134) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam has a ball resilience of >60% (e.g. 60-72%). Ball resilience was tested according to the protocol outlined in ISO standard 8307:1990(E). The test pieces were conditioned and tested at a temperature of 23±2° C. and a humidity of 55±10%.

(135) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam comprises a polyurethane formed by the reaction of at least one polyol having a molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da and an OH functionality of 2-4 with at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%. The polyol and methylene diphenyl diisocyanate may have any one or more of those definitions discussed in respect of the first aspect of the invention.

(136) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam comprises one or more of a chlorinated phosphate ester and a halogen-free phosphate ester fire retardant, or a residue thereof.

(137) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam exhibits BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy. BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy is a UK requirement which is perhaps the most stringent of all international flame retardancy standards. British Standard BS5852 Part 2 1982 entitled "Fire tests for furniture, Part 2. Methods of test for the ignitability of upholstered composites for seating by flaming sources" describes that in the Crib5 test, a wooded crib, made of dry wood stacked in a lattice formation weighing about 17 g, is used as the ignition source and is lowered onto the test material and ignited with a match. If no flaming or progressive smouldering is observed on both cover and interior material and flames self-extinguish within 10 mins, and the mass loss of the test foam pieces is less than 60 g, the test is recorded as 'positive' and the material passes the test. Further details of the test are provided in British Standard BS5852 Part 2 1982.

(138) Achieving high surface-softness, high sag value and BS5852 crib 5 compliance in a single polyurethane foam is particularly advantageous.

(139) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <50 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test. Suitably, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <40 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test. More suitably, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <36 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test.

(140) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam is as defined in any one of numbered paragraphs (31)-(51) below: 31) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 32) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of

33-80, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 33) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 40-70, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 34) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 40-55, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 35) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 70-95, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 36) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 72-85, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 37) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 38) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 40-70, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 39) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 40-55, an IFD65% value of 50-115, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 40) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 70-95, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 41) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 10-40, an IFD40% value of 33-80, an IFD65% value of 72-85, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 42) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of 40-70, an IFD65% value of 70-95, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 43) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of 40-55, an IFD65% value of 72-85, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.5. 44) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of 40-70, an IFD65% value of 70-95, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 45) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-30, an IFD40% value of 40-55, an IFD65% value of 72-85, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.1-3.4. 46) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-24, an IFD40% value of 33-37, an IFD65% value of 70-74, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.2-3.4. 47) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 27-32, an IFD40% value of 41-45, an IFD65% value of 89-93, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.3. 48) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 37-42, an IFD40% value of 60-64, an IFD65% value of 108-112, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 2.8-2.9. 49) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 22-27, an IFD40% value of 39-43, an IFD65% value of 75-80, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.4. 50) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 24-26, an IFD40% value of 39-43, an IFD65% value of 76-79, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.0-3.2. 51) the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 22-25, an IFD40% value of 39-42, an IFD65% value of 78-81, and the IFD25% and IFD65% values are such that the sag value is 3.3-3.4.

(141) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam is as defined in any one of numbered paragraphs (31)-(51), and the foam has a density of 35-60 kg/m.sup.3. Suitably, the foam has a density of 40-60 kg/m.sup.3. More suitably, the foam has a density of 40-55 kg/m.sup.3.

(142) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam is as defined in any one of numbered paragraphs (31)-(51), and the foam has a ball resilience of >60% (e.g. 60-75%).

(143) In an embodiment, the polyurethane foam is as defined in any one of numbered paragraphs (31)-(51), and the foam exhibits BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy. Suitably, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <50 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test. More suitably, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <40 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test. Most suitably, the polyurethane foam exhibits a mass loss of <36 g during the BS5852 Crib5 test.

(144) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (31)-(51), the polyurethane foam

comprises a polyurethane formed by the reaction of at least one polyol having a molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da and an OH functionality of 2-4 with at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%. Suitably, the polyol and methylene diphenyl diisocyanate have any of those definitions discussed hereinbefore in respect of the first aspect of the invention.

(145) In any of the embodiments based on numbered paragraphs (31)-(51), the polyurethane foam is obtainable by the process defined in any of numbered paragraphs (1)-(31) discussed hereinbefore in respect of the first aspect of the invention.

(146) Foam Applications

(147) As described hereinbefore, the present invention also provides an article comprising a polyurethane foam according to the second or third aspect of the invention.

(148) The unique load bearing characteristics of the foams of the present invention make them ideally suited to a variety of applications requiring not only firmness and support, but also surface softness and smoothness.

(149) In an embodiment, the article is a pillow, cushion, mattress, mattress topper, sofa, chair, seat or footwear insole.

(150) The following numbered clauses (1)-(49) are not claims, but instead define particular aspects and embodiments of the invention: 1. A process for the preparation of a polyurethane foam, the process comprising the steps of: a) mixing together the following ingredients in the amounts specified: i. at least one polyol having an average molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2-4, ii. at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%, wherein the amount of diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 65-90, iii. at least one surfactant in an amount of 0.4-1.0 per hundred parts polyol, iv. at least one amine catalyst in an amount of 0.1-0.6 per hundred parts polyol, and v. water in an amount of 1.5-4.0 per hundred parts polyol; b) curing the mixture resulting from step a). 2. The process of clause 1, wherein the ingredients specified in step a) are mixed at a speed of 2,000-8,000 rpm, preferably 4,000-6,000 rpm. 3. The process of clause 1 or 2, wherein the polyol has a molecular weight of 7,000-9,000 Da. 4. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the polyol has an OH functionality of 2.8-3.2. 5. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is a modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate. 6. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate has an NCO content of 28-33%. 7. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the amount of methylene diphenyl diisocyanate relative to the amount of polyol is sufficient to give an ISO index of 70-80. 8. The process of any preceding clause, wherein in step a), the surfactant is present in an amount of 0.4-0.8 per hundred parts polyol. 9. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the amine catalyst is suitable for enhancing the nucleophilicity of the polyol. 10. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the amine catalyst is triethylene diamine. 11. The process of any preceding clause, wherein in step a), the amine catalyst is present in an amount of 0.2-0.4 per hundred parts polyol. 12. The process of any preceding clause, wherein in step a), water is present in an amount of 2.0-3.5 per hundred parts polyol. 13. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one flame retardant in an amount of 3.0-20.0 per hundred parts polyol. 14. The process of clause 13, wherein the flame retardant is present in an amount of 3.0-15.0 per hundred parts polyol, preferably 4.0-10.0 per hundred parts polyol. 15. The process of clause 13 or 14, wherein the flame retardant is a chlorinated phosphate ester, a halogen-free phosphate ester, or a mixture thereof. 16. The process of clause 13, 14 or 15, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one flame retardant synergist in an amount of 8.0-20.0, preferably 8.0-15.0, per hundred parts polyol. 17. The process of clause 16, wherein the flame retardant synergist is melamine-based. 18. The process of clause 16 or 17, wherein the flame retardant synergist is melamine. 19. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one tin catalyst in an amount of

0.01-0.2, preferably 0.01-0.1, per hundred parts polyol. 20. The process of clause 19, wherein the tin catalyst is a mild Lewis acid. 21. The process of clause 19 or 20, wherein the tin catalyst is an alkyl carboxylate. 22. The process of any one of clause 19, 20 or 21, wherein the tin catalyst is stannous octoate. 23. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one of a chain extender and a cross-linker in an amount of 0.2-1.5, preferably 0.6-1.2, per hundred parts polyol. 24. The process of clause 23, wherein the chain extender and/or cross-linker is diethanol amine. 25. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one cell opener in an amount of 1.0-5.0, preferably 2.0-4.0, per hundred parts polyol. 26. The process of clause 25, wherein the cell opener is a polyol-based compound. 27. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise at least one blowing agent in an amount of 3.0-10.0, preferably 6.0-8.0, per hundred parts polyol. 28. The process of clause 27, wherein the blowing agent is methylene chloride. 29. The process of any preceding clause, wherein those ingredients mixed in step a) further comprise a pigment. 30. The process of any preceding clause, wherein in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured in an atmosphere of air. 31. The process of any preceding clause, wherein in step b), the mixture resulting from step a) is cured at a temperature of 15-40° C. and a pressure of 0.9 to 1.1 bar. 32. The process of any preceding clause, wherein the process is a continuous process. 33. The process of clause 32, wherein in step a), the polyol is fed to a mixer at a rate of 100-140 kg/min, preferably 110-130 kg/min. 34. The process of clause 32 or 33, wherein in step a), the methylene diphenyl diisocyanate is fed to a mixer at a rate of 30-80 kg/min, preferably 40-60 kg/min. 35. The process of clause 32, 33 or 34, wherein in step a), the surfactant is fed to a mixer at a rate of 45-85 kg/min, preferably 55-75 kg/min. 36. The process of any one of clause 32 to 35, wherein in step a), the amine catalyst is fed to a mixer at a rate of 20-50 kg/min, preferably 30-40 kg/min. 37. The process of any one of clause 32 to 36, wherein in step a), water is fed to a mixer at a rate of 2-6 kg/min, preferably 3-5 kg/min. 38. A polyurethane foam obtainable by the process of any preceding clause. 39. A polyurethane foam having a sag value of 2.8-3.5, wherein the sag value is calculated according to the following expression:

$$(151) \text{ SagValue} = \frac{\text{IFD65\%}}{\text{IFD25\%}}$$
and wherein IFD65% and IFD25% values are determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008. 40. The polyurethane foam of clause 38 or 39, wherein the polyurethane foam has a sag value of 3.1-3.4. 41. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38, 39 or 40, wherein the polyurethane foam has an IFD25% value of 10-40, preferably 20-30, wherein the IFD25% value is determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008. 42. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 41, wherein the polyurethane foam has an IFD40% value of 20-50, preferably 30-40, wherein the IFD40% value is determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008. 43. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 42, wherein the polyurethane foam has an IFD65% value of 50-100, preferably 60-90, wherein the IFD65% value is determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008. 44. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 43, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-60 kg/m³, preferably 45-50 kg/m³. 45. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 44, wherein the polyurethane foam comprises a polyurethane formed by the reaction of at least one polyol having a molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da and an OH functionality of 2-4 with at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%. 46. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 45, wherein the polyurethane foam comprises one or more of a chlorinated phosphate ester and a halogen-free phosphate ester fire retardant, or a residue thereof. 47. The polyurethane foam of any one of clause 38 to 46, wherein the polyurethane foam exhibits BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy. 48. An article comprising a polyurethane foam according to any one of clause 38 to 47. 49. The article of clause 48, wherein the article is a pillow, cushion, mattress, mattress topper, sofa, chair, seat or footwear insole.

Description

EXAMPLES

(1) One or more examples of the invention will now be described, for the purpose of illustration only, with reference to the accompanying figures, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 shows a continuous foam forming process used in the preparation of the foams of the examples and comparative examples. The process parameters were: mixing head pressure—0.3 MPa; air injection—0.1 L/min; raw materials temperature—22° C.; foaming speed—4.0 m/min; mixing head mixing speed—5000 rpm.

(3) FIG. 2 shows a box foaming (discontinuous) process.

MATERIALS AND METHODS

(4) In following examples, the components used were: Polyol A: Caradol SC56-02 (560H value, 3000 mwt), available from Shell Chemicals Company; Polyol B: GLR2000 (2400H value, 700 mwt), available from Sinopec Shanghai Gaoqiao Chemical Company; Active Polyol C: polyol 330N (330H value 5000 mwt), available from Sinopec Shanghai Gaoqiao Chemical Company; Active polyol D: polyol GEP828 (28 OH value 8000 mwt) from Sinopec Shanghai Gaoqiao Chemical Company; Flame retardant FR508, available from Yoke Chemicals Company; Flame retardant synergist: melamine; Surfactant A: B2470, available from Evonik; Amine catalyst: Niox A1 (available from Momentive) and Dabco 33-LV (available from Air product); Tin Catalyst: K29 from Enovik; Toluene diisocyanate (TDI) is available from BASF; Modified methylene diphenyl diisocyanate (MDI) 6510, available from Huntsmen Chemicals Company (NCO % 29.9); Surfactant B: B8002, available from Evonik; Surfactant L5333 from Momentive; Cell opener: PK101, available from Fushun Chemical Company; Cell opener: KZ28, available from Nanjing Aosai Chemical Co. Blow agent: Methylene chloride; Chain extender/cross linker: Diethanol amine.

(5) In the following examples, foams were prepared using the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1.

Example 1

(6) Having regard to Table 1 below, a flexible polyurethane foam was prepared according to the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1 using the ingredients and amounts specified.

(7) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Ingredients used in the preparation of flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1

Flow rate to mixer	Ingredients	Parts	php*	head (kg/min)
Active polyol D	100	120		
Flame retardant FR 508	7	8.4		
Melamine	10	12		
H.sub.2O	3.2	3.84		
Methylene chloride	7	8.4		
Surfactant L5333	0.55	0.66		
Amine catalyst	0.3	0.36		
Tin Catalyst	0.03	0.04		
Cell opening agent	3	3.6		
Diethanol amine	0.8	0.96		
Modified MDI	40**	48		

*per hundred parts polyol; **amount of MDI was sufficient to give an ISO index of 75.

(8) After forming, the foam was left to cure at room temperature for 72 hours.

(9) The properties (density, sag value and fire retardancy) of the cured flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1 were then assessed. The results are presented in Table 2 below.

(10) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Density, sag value and fire retardancy properties of flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1

Foam density (kg/m.sup.3)	45 IFD25%/N	22.1 IFD40%/N	34.8 IFD65%/N	72.2 Sag value (IFD65%/IFD25%)	3.3 BS5852 crib5 fire retardancy	Pass, 34 g mass loss
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(11) As can be seen from the data presented in Table 2, the IFD25% of the flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1 is 22.1N, which is substantially lower than that observed for conventional, HR and visco-elastic polyurethane foams. This value reflects the high surface softness and smoothness of the flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1 when compared with other polyurethane foams. However in spite of the high surface softness and smoothness, the data presented in Table 2 illustrate that the sag value of the flexible polyurethane foam—which is typically used to gauge the

level of comfort offered by a foam—is 3.3, which is notably higher than that observed for conventional, HR and visco-elastic polyurethane foams. This means that the foam of Example 1, despite having excellent surface softness and smoothness characteristics, also offers remarkable support, without excessive sinking. This is likely due to the fact that whilst the upper surface of the foam is soft, the firmness of the foam increases sharply upon continued application of pressure. (12) In addition to the above, the flexible polyurethane foam of Example 1 meets the BS5852 crib 5 flammability standard—a UK requirement which is perhaps the most stringent of all international flame retardancy standards. Achieving high surface-softness, high sag value and BS5852 crib 5 compliance in a single polyurethane foam is particularly advantageous.

Comparative Example 2—Conventional Flame-Retardant Polyurethane Foam

(13) Having regard to Table 3 below, a flexible conventional flame-retardant polyurethane foam was prepared according to the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1 using the ingredients and amounts specified.

(14) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 Ingredients used in the preparation of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 2 Flow rate to mixer Ingredients Parts/php* head (kg/min) Polyol, A 100 150 Flame retardant FR508 15 22.5 Melamine 30 45 H.sub.2O 3.2 4.8 Methylene chloride 3 4.5 Surfactant A 1.2 1.8 Amine catalyst 0.3 0.45 Tin Catalyst 0.24 0.36 TDI (NCO %: 48.3) 45.6** 68.4 *per hundred parts polyol; **amount of TDI was sufficient to give an ISO index of 115.

(15) After forming, the foam was left to cure at room temperature for 72 hours.

(16) The properties (density, sag value and fire retardancy) of the cured flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 2 were then assessed. The results are presented in Table 4 below.

(17) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Density, sag value and fire retardancy properties of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 1 Foam density (kg/m.sup.3) 32 IFD25%/N 85.5 IFD40%/N 123.2 IFD65%/N 189.5 Sag value (IFD65%/IFD25%) 2.2 BS5852 crib5 Pass, 32 g mass loss

(18) The foam of Comparative Example 2 is a typical BS5852 Crib5-compliant conventional polyurethane foam. Despite being fire retardant, the conventional polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 2 has an extremely high IFD25% value, which manifests itself as poor surface softness characteristics. As a consequence, the foam of Comparative Example 2 is only suitable for use as a base layer in mattresses, and cannot be used in the upper surface on which a consumer sleeps.

Comparative Example 3—Visco-Elastic Polyurethane Foam

(19) Having regard to Table 5 below, a flexible polyurethane visco-elastic foam was prepared according to the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1 using the ingredients and amounts specified.

(20) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 Ingredients used in the preparation of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 3 Flow rate to mixer Ingredients Parts/php* head (kg/min) Polyol A 50 75 Polyol B 50 75 H.sub.2O 2 3 Surfactant B 0.8 1.2 Amine catalyst 0.4 0.6 Tin Catalyst 0.08 0.12 cell open agent 4 6 TDI (NCO %: 48.3) 37.2** 55.8 *per hundred parts polyol; **amount of TDI was sufficient to give an ISO index of 88.

(21) After forming, the foam was left to cure at room temperature for 72 hours.

(22) The properties (density, sag value and fire retardancy) of the cured flexible polyurethane visco-elastic foam of Comparative Example 3 were then assessed. The results are presented in Table 6 below.

(23) TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 6 Density, sag value and fire retardancy properties of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 3 Foam density (kg/m.sup.3) 43 IFD25%/N 30.4 IFD40%/N 43.6 IFD65%/N 60.2 Sag value (IFD65%/IFD25%) 2.0 BS5852 crib5 Fail, burnt out

(24) The foam of Comparative Example 3 is a visco-elastic foam that is widely used in pillows, mattresses and mattress toppers. Although visco-elastic foams offer softness and are able to conform to the body in order to distribute body pressure evenly, they suffer from the standpoint of

providing sufficient support. As can be seen from the data presented in Table 6, sag value of the visco-elastic foam of Comparative Example 3 is only 2.0, which translates to a consumers feeling that they are sunken into the foam, rather than being properly supported by it.

Comparative Example 4—Flame-Retardant HR Polyurethane Foam

(25) Having regard to Table 7 below, a flexible polyurethane HR foam was prepared according to the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1 using the ingredients and amounts specified.

(26) TABLE-US-00007 TABLE 7 Ingredients used in the preparation of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 4 Flow rate to mixer Ingredients Parts/php head (kg/min)* Active polyol C 100 150 Flame retardant 8 12 Melamine 15 18 H.sub.2O 3 4.5 Methylene chloride 3 4.5 Surfactant C 0.6 0.9 Amine catalyst 0.3 0.45 Tin Catalyst 0.1 0.15 Diethanol amine 1 1.5 TDI (NCO %: 48.3) 40.2** 60.3 *per hundred parts polyol; **amount of TDI was sufficient to give an ISO index of 110.

(27) After forming, the foam was left to cure at room temperature for 72 hours.

(28) The properties (density, sag value and fire retardancy) of the cured flexible polyurethane HR foam of Comparative Example 4 were then assessed. The results are presented in Table 8 below.

(29) TABLE-US-00008 TABLE 8 Density, sag value and fire retardancy properties of flexible polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 4 Foam density (kg/m.sup.3) 31 IFD25%/N 67.4 IFD40%/N 100.5 IFD65%/N 182 Sag value 2.7 (IFD65%/IFD25%) BS5852 crib5 Pass, 35 g mass loss

(30) The foam of Comparative Example 4 is a typical BS5852 Crib5-compliant HR polyurethane foam. The foam exhibits good support properties, due in part to the higher molecular weight of polyol used in comparison to conventional and visco-elastic foams, which makes the HR foam widely useable in the seat portion of chairs and sofas. However, the HR polyurethane foam of Comparative Example 4 has an extremely high IFD25% value, which manifests itself as poor surface softness characteristics. As a consequence, the foam of Comparative Example 4 is unsuitable for use in pillows and mattress toppers, wherein high surface-softness is necessary.

Example 5

(31) Having regard to Tables 9 and 10 below, various polyurethane foams were prepared according to the continuous foaming process depicted in FIG. 1 using the ingredients and amounts specified.

(32) TABLE-US-00009 TABLE 9 Composition and properties of various polyurethane foams

Foam	1	2*	3	4*	5	6	FOAM COMPOSITION	Active polyol	D	100	100	100	100	100	100	Cell opener	3	3	3	3	5	KZ28/phpp	Flame retardant	3	20	12	12	12	0	FR508/phpp	Melamine/phpp	15	15	15	15	0	Silicone surfactant	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.7	L5333/phpp	Amine catalyst/phpp	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	Tin catalyst/phpp	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	H2O/phpp	2	2	4	1	2	2	Blow agent/phpp	5	5	5	5	5	2	TEOA/phpp	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	ISO index**	90	90	90	90	90	100	FOAM																																					
PROPERTIES	Cream time/s	10	12	8	30	10	8	Full rising time/s	163	183	125	N/A	172	159	Foam density/kg/m3	54.2	60.4	36.3	N/A	57.2	55.2	IFD 25/40/65(N)	29/43/91	29.3/41.1/78.2	39.5/62/110.2	N/A	25.2/41.3/77.2	23.5/40.3/79.2	Sag value	3.1	2.67	2.8	N/A	3.1	3.4	Ball resilience/%	62	52	50	N/A	65	69	Overall foam physical	5	2	3	N/A	5	5	performance (1-5; 1 = poor, 5 = excellent)	FR BS5852 crib 5 test	Fail.	Foam Pass.	Mass Fail.	Foam N/A	Pass.	Mass Fail.	Foam continued burning loss	38 g	continued loss	35 g	continued after 10 mins.	after 4 mins	burning after	after 4 mins	burning after	Mass loss	>60 g	35 sec	10 mins.	55 sec	10 mins.	Mass loss	>60 g	Mass loss	>60 g	Comments	Foam exhibits BS5852 crib	Higher water	Low water	BS5852 crib	Foam exhibits excellent	5 compliant,	content gave	content	5 compliant	excellent	physical	physical	properties. but high con-	rise to certain	hampered and	excellent	properties. Lack	Not enough	tent of	flame defects in	foam, foam rising.	physical of	flame	flame	retardant	retardant	and overall	Sample not	properties	retardant	meant to confer	BS5852	compromised	poorer	cured	foam was not	crib 5	compliance	physical	proper-	physical	BS5852	crib	ties of	foam	properties	5 compliant

*comparative example; **ISO index achieved by adding appropriate amount of modified MDI; phpp - per hundred parts polyol

(33) TABLE-US-00010 TABLE 10 Composition and properties of various polyurethane foams

Foam	7*	8*	9*	10*	11*	12*	FOAM COMPOSITION	Active polyol	D	100	100	100	100	100	100
Cell opener	3	3	3	3	3	3	KZ28/phpp	Flame retardant	12	12	12	12	12	12	FR508/phpp
	15	15	15	15	15	15	Silicone surfactant	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.1	2	L5333/phpp	Amine catalyst/phpp
	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	Tin catalyst/phpp	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.05	H2O/phpp	2
	5	5	5	5	5	2	TEOA/phpp	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	ISO index**	90
	90	90	70	120	90	90	FOAM PROPERTIES	Cream time/s	40	2	16	8	11	10	Full rising time/s
	NA	81	192	150	NA	172	Foam density/kg/m3	NA	NA	65.2	55.2	NA	NA	IFD 25/40/65(N)	NA
	NA	NA	14.2/24.2/45.2	40.4/65.8/110.8	NA	NA	Sag value	NA	NA	3.2	2.7	NA	NA	Ball resilience/%	NA
	NA	NA	53	52	NA	NA	Overall foam physical	NA	1	2	2	1	1	performance (1-5; 1 = poor, 5 = excellent)	FR BS5852
	Fail.	Foam Pass.	Mass	NA	NA	continued burning loss	28 g after 10 mins.	after 3	Mass loss	>60 g	mins	56 sec	Comments	Insufficient	Excessive amount
	Low	ISO index	High	ISO	Insufficient	Excessive amount of of amine	resulted in index	resulted amount of amount	amine catalyst	caused	overly soft	in overly	surfactant of	surfactant catalyst	foam to rise
	foam	having	firm	foam	led to	led to	for foam	too quickly,	poor support	having	larger cells,	closed cell	to rise	causing	characteristics.
	a closed	causing	foam	structure,	splitting	Flame cell	structure	collapse	while	causing	retardancy	also	and	poor	rising
	foam	shrinkage	compromised	surface	after	curing	smoothness	*comparative	example;	**ISO	index	achieved	by	adding	appropriate
	amount	of	modified	MDI;	phpp	-	per	hundred	parts	polyol					

(34) The results presented in Tables 9 and 10 illustrate the effect of varying the amount of the various ingredients of the foam.

(35) While specific embodiments of the invention have been described herein for the purpose of reference and illustration, various modifications will be apparent to a person skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A polyurethane foam having a sag value of 3.2-3.4, wherein the sag value is calculated according to the following expression: $\text{SagValue} = \frac{\text{IFD65\%}}{\text{IFD25\%}}$ wherein the polyurethane foam has: an IFD25% value of 20-24 N, an IFD40% value of 33-37 N, an IFD65% value of 70-74 N, and wherein the IFD25%, IFD40%, and IFD65% values are determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008.
2. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam has a ball resilience of >60%, wherein the ball resilience is tested according to the protocol set forth in ISO standard 8307: 1990 (E).
3. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 35-60 kg/m.sup.3.
4. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam exhibits BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy.
5. An article comprising a polyurethane foam according to claim 1.
6. The article of claim 5, wherein the article is a pillow, cushion, mattress, mattress topper, sofa, chair, seat or footwear insole.
7. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-60 kg/m.sup.3.
8. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-55 kg/m.sup.3.
9. The polyurethane foam of claim 1, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 45-50 kg/m.sup.3.
10. A polyurethane foam having a sag value of 3.3-3.4, wherein the sag value is calculated according to the following expression: $\text{Sagvalue} = \frac{\text{IFD65\%}}{\text{IFD25\%}}$ wherein the polyurethane foam has: an

IFD25% value of 22-25 N, an IFD40% value of 39-42 N, an IFD65% value of 78-81 N, and wherein the IFD25%, IFD40%, and IFD65% values are determined according to the protocol set forth in ISO 2439:2008.

11. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam has a ball resilience of >60%, wherein the ball resilience is tested according to the protocol outlined in ISO standard 8307:1990 (E).

12. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 35-60 kg/m.³.

13. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam comprises a polyurethane formed by the reaction of at least one polyol having a molecular weight of 6,000-12,000 Da and an OH functionality of 2-4 with at least one methylene diphenyl diisocyanate having an NCO content of 26-33%.

14. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam exhibits BS5852 Crib5 fire retardancy.

15. An article comprising a polyurethane foam according to claim 10.

16. The article of claim 15, wherein the article is a pillow, cushion, mattress, mattress topper, sofa, chair, seat or footwear insole.

17. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-60 kg/m.³.

18. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 40-55 kg/m.³.

19. The polyurethane foam of claim 10, wherein the polyurethane foam has a density of 45-50 kg/m.³.
